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Elected Officials

- Diane Saxe, Ward 11 Councillor

City Staff

- Becky Katz, Manager of Toronto Cycling and Pedestrian Project
- Joshua Bowman, Ward 17 Director of Policy & Stakeholder Relations

Non-Profit Organizations

- David Simor, The Centre for Active Transportation Director
- Laura Smith, Park People
- Geoff Kettel, FoNTRA & Cycle Don Valley Midtown

Advocacy Groups & Advocates

- Lanrick Bennet Jr., Bike Mayor
- Alison Stewart, CycleTO
- Sean Marshall, WalkTO
- Holly Reid, Cycle Don Valley Midtown
- Naija Zewari, Women’s Cycling & Cycle Don Valley Midtown

ACTIVE AND SUSTAINABLE TRANSPORTATION NETWORKS

FINAL REPORT

PREPARED FOR: TENBLOCK

This report was completed as part of meeting the requirements for the Bachelor of Urban and Regional Planning (BURPI)

Toronto Metropolitan University

TENBLOCK

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1 INTRODUCTION

In this collaborative partnership between TMU's (Toronto Metropolitan University) School of Urban and Regional Planning and Tenblock, I explored opportunities to improve active transportation around five of the company's development projects. Through research analysis and advocacy, the students identified one target initiative that would benefit most from Tenblock's sustainable living initiatives to create an environment that promotes active transportation. This report outlines the selection of bike lane improvements around 48 Grenoble Drive and advocating for a bike lane implementation along Don Mills Road as my target initiatives, as well as the stakeholder identification and engagement process that informed the advocacy plan. The advocacy plan consists of a list of recommended actions that Tenblock should undertake in order to support the implementation of the target initiatives, promoting the active transportation network around their site within Flemingdon Park.

1.1 Priorities & Goals

The goal of this project is to foster thriving communities interconnected by safe and efficient active transportation networks. Together with Tenblock, I envision a future where their development projects serve as hubs of sustainable urban living. By evaluating opportunities and prioritizing a target initiative, I aim to set a standard for integrating sustainable transportation practices into urban development. This project aligns with the City's goal to reduce carbon emissions, minimize congestion, and promote physical activity through the implementation of safe cycling infrastructure.

In this report, my goal is to present a series of recommendations for Tenblock aimed at enhancing the active transportation network around their site at 48 Grenoble Drive. To achieve this, I engaged with multiple stakeholders who shared invaluable insights. I have detailed my discussions with these stakeholders to provide the rationale behind my finalized advocacy plan.

1.2 Vision Statement

United in my commitment to sustainability and active transportation, I envision a future where Tenblock's development projects serve as vibrant centers of sustainable urban living. Through detailed research, opportunity analyses, and advocacy for my chosen initiative, my vision is to contribute to a future where residents can seamlessly navigate their surroundings while minimizing their environmental footprint. In collaboration with Tenblock, one of Toronto's most cycling-supportive developers, I am committed to setting a new standard for the integration of sustainable transportation practices in urban development and shaping a future where sustainable living is not just a concept but a reality embraced by all.

2 48 GRENOBLE DRIVE

The Interim report concluded with the selection of 48 Grenoble Drive as the main focus site for the advocacy plan. Located in Don Valleys East's Flemingdon Park Neighbourhood, this redevelopment location was deemed the most promising site to focus on based on the following considerations:

- The site's **existing conditions** were considered to be poor, as evident by the state of the bike lanes which have not been updated since their original implementation in 2017 (City of Toronto, n.d). The existing cycling infrastructure has minimal design features and lacks protective measures, such as physical barriers, as the current infrastructure relies on painted lines as borders from the rest of the streetscape. This design feature often leads to cars parking on bike lanes, especially prominent in school zones where this becomes hazardous for cyclists and vulnerable groups.
- The anticipated **future growth** of the area is a significant asset. The site's proximity to the Ontario Line and Eglinton LRT will increase the level of development activity and residents in the neighbourhood (Metrolinx, 2022). As a result, the demand for better cycling infrastructure conditions will need to be accommodated alongside the expansion of other transportation networks.
- Flemingdon Park neighbourhood has a strong history of **neighbourhood support**, as cycling advocacy groups and nonprofit organizations are well-integrated and actively involved within the community. The area is rich in cycling-oriented stakeholders, meaning that any active transportation advocacy work for the project would align with the neighbourhood's existing priorities.
- Several new **connective networks** are planned or underway in the site's surrounding context. The City of Toronto's 2025-2027 cycling network plan includes intersection redevelopments and new bike lane enhancements, but the plan still leaves connection and infrastructure gaps (City of Toronto, 2024).

2.1 Demographics

Prior to making any final decisions, I examined the site's demographics. As a neighbourhood improvement zone, the project must ensure that any proposed initiatives will work towards giving citizens equitable opportunities and enhancing transportation accessibility to local amenities.

The demographic profile of the neighbourhood showed that the neighbourhood has a significant immigrant population, with 84% of residents belonging to visible minority groups (see Figure 1. in the Appendix). From this 84%, the most common ethnicity populations in the neighbourhood include South Asian (38%), Black (12%), West Asian (12%), Filipino (9%), and Chinese (4%) (see Figure 2. in the Appendix. As well, based on data from 2016, 46% of the neighbourhood's population relied on public transit when commuting to work. Considering the anticipated increase in population growth and new immigration, it is reasonable to project that these figures have increased since then (CanadIM, 2023). Moving forward with the project, I recognize the community's evolving needs and will promote equitability within all active transportation strategies.

All data is generated from Statistics Canada's 2021 Census.

2.2 Chosen Opportunity

Once I finalized 48 Grenoble Drive as the chosen location, I evaluated five proposed opportunities to select one final strategy for the site. These opportunities varied in interventions and included the following:

- Bike Lane Condition Upgrades and Don Mills Road Cycling Connection Expansion;
- Public Bike Shelter and Storage Implementations;
- Educational Cycling Program Incorporation;
- Speed Hump Additions;
- Pedestrian Crosswalk Upgrades.

To strategically select one equitable and practical opportunity, I created a criteria chart to grade each opportunity based on its political support, the associated cost, the existing planned directions, existing advocacy efforts, and the integration process to determine which option would be best supported overall (see Figure 3. in the Appendix). After an extensive review, I decided that upgrading the bike lane conditions around 48 Grenoble Drive and implementing a new bike lane along Don Mills Road would be the most practicable decision (see Figure 4. in the Appendix).

The proposed intervention was best supported by the objectives and future development plans in Toronto's Official Plan (City of Toronto, 2023). From a financial perspective, providing better safety-supported cycling infrastructure would be inexpensive, as any money invested in the project would also be invested back into the neighbourhood, supporting its economic growth through bike lane improvements (CBC, 2019). Also, the location will become a major transit station area once the two transportation lines are constructed and will have to be supported with various cycling connections and will prioritize the increase in density. Lastly, the opportunity establishes the most connections with surrounding amenities, parks, transportation services, and neighbourhoods, ultimately providing benefits to more than just the residents of 48 Grenoble Drive. It is further supported by the extensive number of cycling advocacy groups found within the neighbourhood and the residents' concerns mentioned on the City of Toronto's Interactive feedback map for the 2025-2027 candidate bike lanes (City of Toronto, 2024).

2.3 Travel Times

To provide more context behind the efficacy of cycling as a form of transportation within the Flemingdon Park Neighbourhood, the Figure 5. map and Figure 6. chart as seen in the Appendix compare the time it takes to get to key locations from the 48 Grenoble Drive site with different modes of transportation. These modes included biking, driving, public transportation, and walking. When comparing the travel times, it was noticeable that cycling was often a quicker transit option than walking or using public transportation. When compared to the driving commute, cycling took only 1-5 minutes longer but was the second best option and most affordable one. These findings confirm the advantages and accessibility opportunities cycling can have on the Flemingdon and Thorncliffe communities and prove how efficient well-supported cycling networks can be when implemented well.

3 STAKEHOLDERS

The first part of my research consisted of identifying potential stakeholders to contact and find out more about their advocacy efforts and experiences. I identified stakeholders and noted them down in the provided Excel Sheet template with stakeholder categories that Tenblock used for their previous project. Some of the most notable categories included: Residents Associations, Community Stakeholder Groups, Advocacy Groups, City Staff, and Cycling Groups. Some other categories included: Residential Building Operators or Associations, Local Businesses of Interest, and Media.

When picking the stakeholders, I did a thorough research on organizations and groups that have been or are currently involved in advocacy for active transportation. This research consisted of compiling my previous knowledge of some organizations and groups, but also learning about new groups and figures through browsing on the internet. After finalizing my list of stakeholders who I believe I would benefit from connecting with, I utilized their websites and social media platforms to gather their contact details.

3.1 Connecting with Stakeholders

Tenblock Connections - I forwarded the complete Stakeholder Excel Sheet (see Link 1. in the Appendix) to Tenblock to inquire about any contact information, after which they sent me back a shortened list of stakeholders whom they had personal connections with (see Link 2. in the Appendix). They reached out to some stakeholders, asking them if they were available to connect with me and further discuss my proposal. This saved me a lot of time and connected me to the majority of the people that I have identified as the most important stakeholders.

Cold-Calling - On multiple occasions, I would opt for cold-calling stakeholders if their contact information was available on a website or platform. Through this approach, I aimed to arrange meetings with stakeholders over the phone, believing it to be a more efficient and effective means of communication. I thought that this method would give me immediate interaction and enhanced productivity with stakeholders, but it turned out that many people were not into talking over the phone about this specific matter.

Cold Emailing - If I did not have direct contact with them through Tenblock, or had their phone number, I would send cold emails informing them about what I are doing and asking them if they are interested in further communicating with me. This method was effective a couple of times, but was harder to navigate, as I only had a couple of weeks to connect.

Online Forms - There were a couple of non-profit organizations that provided specific online forms for contacting them, which became a prevalent strategy for me. I assume that some organizations preferred this method as it enabled them to efficiently manage and track incoming inquiries. While this approach did not always give me responses, it did help me make a final connection with three important stakeholders.

I approached all meetings and conversations with an understanding of the work a stakeholder does, so that I were able to get insightful information, instead of generalized knowledge.

Some general questions that I asked all stakeholders contacted include:

- **"Have you engaged in advocacy efforts for this or a similar initiative, and if so, do you have any examples of strategies you've used that would be helpful for my project?"**
  - This question aimed to understand how existing organizations approach advocacy. I hoped to internalize feedback to produce specific and appropriate advocacy strategies.
- **"Do you have any feedback to give me based on the information I have shared with you? Any specific concerns?"**
  - I wanted to get any critiques and advice on the actions I have taken so far since I must understand ways I can create a comprehensive plan.
- **"How do you see the community engaged in this project? What can I do to build consensus and gain support from other stakeholders, including residents and businesses?"**
  - Similarly to the first question, the goal of this question was to gain an understanding of any approaches that I can recommend my client to take when further advocating for this proposal.
- **"Are there any challenges you foresee in implementing this bike lane and upgrades in the area?"**
  - I aimed to understand potential challenges, beyond my scope of understanding.

In the end, I ended up connecting with **11 stakeholders** through 9 meetings, including Google Meets calls and in-person bike rides and walks.

Virtual meetings were a more popular form of communication after connecting with stakeholders, as many of them were busy during this time. Understanding the professionals' perspectives showed me that there are multiple methods that I can use and they gave me great examples of work that they have done in the past that I could implement. From engaging with professionals, it gave me an idea of areas that I should focus on and how I could make this a successful project.

I had the opportunity to meet two of the stakeholders **in person**. This was a strategy I went through because it gave me a personal and interactive connection with them while engaging with the environment. I got to gain a deep understanding of their perspective, priorities, and experiences through this method, as well as find out more about the 48 Grenoble Drive site and its surrounding areas.

As I were meeting with them, I started developing a **Stakeholder Web** to showcase all the professionals I met with. When finalized, this web had eleven stakeholders that I connected with, all grouped into 4 sections - City Staff, Elected Officials, Non-Profit Organizations, and Advocacy Groups & Advocates (see Figure 7. in the Appendix).

3.2 Stakeholder Interviews

The interviews with stakeholders are presented in chronological order, from my first meeting to the last. All stakeholders agreed that community engagement is a key component of advocacy planning, and many stakeholders had similar ideas. This section will outline the main points from my conversations with stakeholders, with every interview building on its preceding ones.

3.2.1 Dianne Saxe (Ward 11 Councillor)

Councillor Dianne Saxe from Ward 11 was the first stakeholder I met with. From the perspective of a Councillor, Dianne taught me how important it is to engage with a community to gain support. I took what I found out through my interview with her, and decided that the main focus of the recommenda- tions for Tenblock will be gaining community support.

One of the first things that the Councillor told me was that building public support is a major obstacle in promoting bike lanes. As Toronto is a car-centric city, and people are used to using their private motorized vehicles as their main form of transportation, it may be hard to convince the public to try out other modes of transportation. I believe that the Councillor on this topic and thought that it is even harder to convince people to use bikes when the infrastructure for them is either very poor or nonexistent.

After my interview with her, I thought, "What better way to engage with a community and understand their views on my proposal than through a survey?" I thought this would reveal the interests of residents, businesses, and institutions in the area, and help my client gain local support on the matter.

She recommended that I ask the residents what kind of bike lanes they would like to see, rather than to go into the community engagement with a plan of what they will look like. She said that ensuring the safety of bike lanes and their importance in the area would be the best way to approach local stakeholders.

Key Takeaways

- Engaging with the community is key in gaining support for the opportunity
- Understanding the public perception of private motorized vehicles being still the primary mode of transportation. Tenblock must ensure that residents don't feel that they are losing this transportation option in the addition of these bike lanes
- Conducting surveys within the community can provide valuable information into residents and stakeholders' views regarding the opportunities
- Gather input on what type of bike lane and safety precautions the community prefers to prioritize their needs
- Highlighting the safety benefits and connectivity of bike lanes for the community can be a persuasive approach to gaining support

3.2.2 Lanrick Bennet Jr. (Bicycle Mayor)

Lanrick Bennet Jr., Toronto's first appointed Bicycle Mayor, has a history of civic engagement and has worked on multiple projects supporting active transportation and environmental protection. My interview with him was a very interesting one, as he took me on a cycling tour from the Flemingdon Park neighbourhood to Danforth's Greek Town to show the existing conditions and connections of the bike lanes in the area and give me some insight into strategies for advocacy planning.

Lanrick talked about the importance of having visuals and diagrams that can better explain the project's goals to the community. Visual aids can help convey complex ideas much easier and give stakeholders a better picture of the future of the area with the right steps. This is when I got the idea to include a map in my survey, showing the existing and proposed bike lanes in the area.

Lanrick also gave me different examples of how Tenblock can get more involved with the community. One example was to organize cycling tours with residents, similar to how my meeting with Lanrick went. Our bike ride with Lanrick proved that when you give neighbourhoods efficient cycling infrastructure, biking to a destination can be quicker, more engaging, and more relaxing than riding public transportation which may take longer considering traffic and congestion.

A great focus was also put on providing safe connections to the educational facilities in the neighbourhood. For instance, Thorncliffe Park is home to the Fraser Mustard Early Learning Academy, one of the largest all-day kindergarten schools in North America. It is clear that this location has a massive population of younger families with children and is heavily populated with elementary schools and high schools, yet almost all of the school zones have a speed limit of 40 km/h. Lanrick recommended that on top of promoting safer cycling infrastructure, reviewing whether the school safety zones have efficient traffic calming measures should also be a priority as this goes hand in hand with keeping cyclists safe.

Lanricks' suggestions can help this neighbourhood become more inclusive, vibrant, and sustainable, but this can only be achieved if the aspirations and needs of residents are reflected in how I build and design infrastructure.

Key Takeaways

- Organizing cycling tours with residents, to show the current conditions of the network, and educate them on the connectivity and safe cycling procedures.
- Add images and maps to the survey to create an easier understanding for residents and stakeholders.
- Think about creating safe bike connections around schools
    - Reviewing the school safety zones for efficient traffic calming measures should also be a priority

3.2.3 David Simor (TCAT)

David Simor is the Director of The Center for Active Transportation (TCAT) and a key stakeholder and expert for me to consult. Due to TCAT's efforts to understand the data before successfully introducing active transportation systems in different urban contexts, it was essential to get insight from David's experience with advocacy. TCAT has worked on many surveys, research projects, and community initiatives to understand the demands and impacts of proposed local transportation, which are directly reflected in my work for Tenblock. TCAT's promotion of cycling initiatives and intensive experience with similar projects make them a significant stakeholder in my Advocacy Plan in Flemingdon Park.

The conversation with David was very insightful. He had a lot of knowledge of the social and transportation conditions of Flemingdon Park, so he understood my advocacy efforts for bike lanes for the community. He provided a different perspective on the need to involve unconventional stakeholders in my plan, such as local farmers and economic stakeholders, who will experience the biggest change once the bike lanes have been implemented. It is their customers who will have to change their entire route to commute to their businesses and therefore, should have a large say during the planning and advocacy stages of the initiative.

David was strong in reinforcing that public projects run by private developers may lead to unintentional displacement Given the demographic and historical makeup of Flemingdon Park, it is critical that my advocacy plan internalizes community engagement and input from them. David suggested I go further and find local community groups such as biking clubs to champion advocacy and promotion efforts. A local will have critical insight into successful ways to engage the community, which is key to creating well-integrating transportation projects.

David detailed the implementation of bike lanes with conscious design. During my conversation, I told him I are measuring success by seeing the community utilize the lanes for short essential trips, such as going to the grocery store instead of opting for their vehicles. Those who bike to shop will likely have larger cargo bikes, needing wider bike lanes to accommodate them safely. David mentioned that, to see positive results, I need to put thought into how the results will develop.

Key Takeaways

- TCAT's research highlighted the strong desire for improved bike infrastructure in the Flemingdon Park and Thorncliffe Park communities - emphasizing the importance of community engagement.
- Engaging with local community leaders and champions to build a strong connection and support beyond the community.
- Hiring local figures to lead events and initiatives like a community bike ride, creating openness among residents
- David prompted me to consider how the proposal will directly benefit the community, leading the team to expand the survey to gather more insights on residents' transportation needs and hopes.

3.2.4 Becky Katz (Cycling Project Manager)

Becky Katz is the manager of Toronto's cycling and pedestrian projects. I decided to meet with Becky because of her expertise and insights on the current conditions of the transportation systems in the Flemmingdon Park and Throncliffe areas. After introducing my project to Becky, she let me know that she thinks that what I are proposing is inevitably going to happen in the near future. She told me that with the new Ontario Line station in the area, Metrolinx is looking into implementing bike lanes along the Don Mills Road. Hearing this was motivating and gave me some insight on how Metrolinx can be a stakeholder that Tenblock could potentially get in contact with.

During my meeting, Becky shared some really useful links with me, most of which were based on the improvements in the area. She shed light on some of the ongoing projects in the area, such as the enhancement of Deauville Lane intersections at Saint Dennis Drive and Grenoble Drive, as well as the South of Overlea Boulevard bike trail and the Overlea bridge expansion and improvement.

As my conversation unwinded, Becky explained some of her recommendations for engaging with the community. This is where the idea of pop-up engagement came into play, telling me that she had done many in the past in collaboration with some of my other stakeholders. She explained that implementing this type of engagement allows for all voices to be heard, specifically those who are not willing or able to go to traditional meetings. She brought up the importance of engaging with people in their everyday environments, rather than making them come to you. She said that this is the best way to get opinions of residents with different backgrounds.

Key Takeaways

- Although the bike lane extension on Don Mills is not in the 2025-2027 extension, it is going to happen in the near future due to the new Ontario Line Station being implemented in the area
  - Metrolinx is currently looking at the implementation of this bike lane, acknowledging that they would be an ideal stakeholder for the advocacy efforts
- Insight into ongoing transportation projects in the area, which includes:
  - The enhancement of Deauville Lane intersections at Saint Dennis Drive and Grenoble Drive
  - Extension of the South of Overlea Boulevard bike trail ending on Don Mills Road (reiterating that the extension of the bike lane on Don Mills Road would be ideal in terms of connecting the trail to existing bike lanes)
  - Overlea bridge expansion and improvement
- The recommendation of pop engagement is to allow more voices to be heard. She encouraged me to be creative and have some fun with community engagement

3.2.5 Sean Marshall (WalkTO)

Coming from a pedestrian-oriented, civic advocacy background, Sean Marshall gave the me important feedback on how to activate the public realm around the site. As the Co-founder of WalkTO, Sean focused on the concerns facing walkability and connectivity between the Flemingdon and Thorncliffe Park neighbourhoods.

Similarly to my other stakeholders, Sean talked about the importance of community engagement. One way that he recommended I do this was by conducting walking audit assessments. This would help me get a better understanding of how the community interacts with the neighbourhood's environment and what areas need infrastructure improvements. This research would also provide a stronger analysis of any barriers in the walkability of the site and the design conditions of intersections.

Sean also emphasized the importance of designing spaces that support mixed-use development. Keeping in mind how this area will look in the future once the Ontario Line and Eglinton LRT are in full effect, the meeting helped me further think about how the street design can better foster a sense of community, how it can support local businesses, and how it can make the area safer for every member of the community.

He highlighted the renewal project for the Overlea Boulevard Bridge and how this would positively affect the neighbourhood. In looking at this bridge connection, he showed me examples of long-term projects like the Tawatinâ LRT bridge in Edmonton Alberta to show the effect well-done infrastructure can have on the public realm as well as how infrastructure can be designed to support all forms of active transportation.

Implementing safer bike lane infrastructure can make streets safer for pedestrians too. Keeping this in mind during the design process of the bike lanes will be integral to supporting the making of a complete community and will better align the project with Toronto's Vision Zero strategies.

Key Takeaways

- Conducting walking audit assessments
  - What areas need infrastructure improvements
- Support the mixed-use developments
- Understand how the area will look in the future and plan for innovative improvements
- Infrastructure should have a positive impact on the public realm and be designed to support all forms of active transportation
- Implementing safer bike lane infrastructure can make streets safer for pedestrians too

3.2.6 Alison Stewart (CycleTO)

Alison is the Director of Advocacy and Public Policy at CycleTO. Similarly to Becky, Alison provided extensive background information about the site's existing and future initiatives. She noted that the renewal of the Overlea Bridge was a huge advocacy effort involving many different parties. She explained that the advocacy efforts involved teachers from local schools, organized community engagement celebrations to support City Staff, and residents sharing their feedback. This approach made sure that everyone knew that this project prioritized the entire public realm of the bridge, not just the bikeways.

Using the previous example, collaborating closely with local community groups will be pivotal in the project's scope. Alison specifically recommended getting teachers involved with the proposal, as this would be a great way to get key community members involved in the conversation of cycling safety and connectivity.

From her previous experience, she recommended working with the Cycle Don Valley Ward group, as they were the ones who originally reached out to local schools and other stakeholders when working on the Overlea safety improvements project. She also recommended working with the Womens Cycling Network to help build a stronger culture of biking in the area and give residents access to bike training if they need extra support.

Additionally, she recommended identifying a list of community groups that have previously signed up to attend consultations in the neighbourhood, such as any Metrolinx presentations; as these groups may be more interested in discussing active transportation infrastructure development.

She also noted that identifying the site's demographics will also be a necessary step before going out to meet with community members. Knowing what the common first languages are, and the important multicultural services and religious institutions are as well, can be helpful due to the community being highly populated with immigrants. Meeting residents at a halfway point by respecting their valued spaces can help build a trusting relationship and can help get the community further involved in the civic process.

Key Takeaways

- The renewal of the Overlea Bridge
  - Prioritized the entire public realm
- Involving teachers is the key to starting the conversation about cycling safety
- Working with local groups to organize events
  - Cycle Don Valley Midtown
  - Women's Cycling Network
- Finding members that have previously signed up to attend consultations in the neighbourhood
- Attending Councillor and MPP events to talk to community members

3.2.7 Cycle Don Valley Midtown

The following three stakeholders are members of Cycle Don Valley Midtown, which is the cycling advocacy group for Wards 15 and 16. The meeting with the community's cycling advocates was informative and significant because they have experience undertaking advocacy efforts for the implementation of bike lanes within Flemingdon Park.

3.2.7.1 Geoff Kettel (FoNTRA)

Geoff Kettel is a member of both Cycle Don Valley Midtown and the Federation of North Toronto Residents' Associations (FoNTRA). He served as my main point of contact to the advocacy group. Collectively, I echoed that all successful advocacy efforts use a "multi-pronged approach" that addresses various perspectives and concerns on an initiative. Because this form of approach requires input and support from various groups, community outreach and organization are key. Geoff had multiple recommendations on this front.

Seeing as Flemingdon Park is a family-oriented neighbourhood that contains numerous schools, Geoff recommends connecting with the surrounding schools for the advocacy plan. In addition to being a relevant party because implementing bike lanes results in a safer streetscape for students, the schools already have established connections that can be used to interact with the community. He also highlights the active role the schools have played in past advocacy efforts for road improvements along Overlea Boulevard, where they help facilitate community gatherings and host events. Collaborating with the schools would be beneficial given their ability to help mobilize community support.

Another recommendation from Geoff emphasizes the significance of gaining support from local businesses as they play a big role in the local economy, giving them a stronger influence on municipal decision-making. If local businesses unite in support of an initiative that would benefit their business and contribute to the local economy, it would be challenging for the Ward Councillor to oppose it.

He was also able to provide me with contacts from the Flemingdon Thorncliffe Interagency Network (FTIAN) and TP/FP Grassroots Leaders Network, which will be helpful in future communications and outreach.

3.2.7.2 Najia Zewari (Women's Cycling)

Najia Zewari is a Co-Chair for Cycle Don Valley Midtown and the founder of the Women's Cycling Network. I was not able to establish a connection with the Women's Cycling Network so it was very fortunate that I was able to speak with Najia alongside the other advocacy group members. The major lesson from Najia was the value of community advice as "you would be surprised how well residents know their neighbourhood and their needs.

Najia's recommendations centered around utilizing the skills and existing connections of influential community figures. She highlights that there are already community organizers within the neighbourhood and emphasizes the value of leveraging existing communication platforms like group chats to spread information effectively. Additionally, Najia noted that Flemingdon Park is a newcomer community, with English not being the primary language for most residents. To address this, she recommends distributing flyers in multiple languages and collaborating closely with trusted community figures who can facilitate clarification and mediation.

Najia highlighted that one of the most impactful actions Tenblock can take is to sponsor and fund advocacy events, demonstrating active participation and fostering stronger relationships with the community.

3.2.7.3 Holly Reid (Cycle Don Valley Midtown)

Holly Reid is another Co-Chair for Cycle Don Valley Midtown. In addition to echoing the advice and recommendations of her fellow group members, she also recounted their advocacy efforts for the improvements along Overlea Boulevard so as to provide me with an applicable example.

When advocating for the bike lanes along Overlea Boulevard, they made sure to include that implementation would also contribute to improving the streetscape and pedestrian safety. They addressed concerns regarding vehicular traffic, as Holly stated to "make sure that people that drive are not losing a lot". This consideration demonstrates the efficiency of the "multi-pronged" approach that has been echoed by many of the stakeholders. It proved to be effective as the improvements along Overlea Boulevard approved with consideration of pedestrian safety and vehicular traffic concerns in addition to the bike lanes (the Overlea and Don Mills intersection is being transformed to better accommodate pedestrians and all motor vehicle lanes will be maintained).

Holly also recognized that successful advocacy efforts require support from all levels because it comes down to convincing City Officials. As a result, she recommends that Tenblock should undertake initiatives that may be challenging for existing advocacy groups to accomplish. An example of this is garnering support from other landowners and developers within Flemingdon Park as these parties have stronger and more influential relationships with City Staff.

Key Takeaways

- Utilizing the skills of community figures and existing connections
- Encouraging Tenblock to take initiatives that are challenging for advocacy groups to accomplish
- Using the 'multi-pronged approach" to address multiple concerns like pedestrian safety, traffic, and streetscape to gain broader support
- Collaborate with community figures who can help with conveying information in other languages
- Providing funding for collaborators

3.2.8 Laura Smith (Park People)

Laura is a senior project manager at Park People, a non-profit organization that helps people activate the power of parks to improve the quality of life in cities across Canada. As all other stakeholders mentioned before, Laura also stressed the importance of community engagement. As she was one of the last people I interviewed, she helped tie the whole report together.

One of the most important takeaways from my conversation with Laura was the importance of inclusion. As mentioned in the demographics section of the report, the Flemingdon Park neighbourhood has a lot of newcomers to Canada, so for many, English is not their first language. Laura was familiar with this information as well and recommended that I translate everything I propose or put out into other prevalent languages spoken within the community.

Her feedback was very similar to Becky's. She recommended pop-up engagement but went into detail about the strategies to host one. She emphasized that recognizing not everyone is deeply engaged in local politics is the initial step in organizing a successful pop-up engagement event. Laura also highlighted that showing up to a community meeting and genuinely wanting to participate, are very different. From her experience, she gathered that having exciting events is key to passing down information successfully. This is why she recommended I incorporate interactive elements within both organized community meetings and pop-up engagement events. Compensating people for their time with care packages, food, drinks, and such, is an important element of these kinds of engagements as well.

Laura also told me that organizing these meetings regularly was a crucial part of constantly building relationships with the community. It's not only important to engage with the community but also to stay in contact with them. Sharing all the information with the community members as soon as it's available is one way to continue to foster this relationship.

Another important recommendation that I got from Laura is to add a demographic component to my survey. Looking at StatsCan tells me the numbers, but it does not connect it to my proposal. She explained that I might come to some new interesting conclusions, seeing as many women generally feel less safe biking than men. Understanding how one's identity and background might impact their experience with cycling in the city is a crucial part of developing a proposal that is inclusive of all demographics.

Key Takeaways

- Importance of inclusion
- Some people are not or may not want to be involved in local politics
- Successful pop-up events:
  - Host in a familiar environment
  - Have exciting and engaging events
  - Incorporate interactive elements
  - Offer compensation
  - Host regularly to foster relationships

3.2.9 Joshua Bowman (Ward 17 Director of Policy & Stakeholder Relations)

Joshua Bowman is Ward 17 Councillor Carol's director of policy and stakeholder relations and a budgeting lead. Being a representative of the surrounding Ward to my site, it is essential that I understand their political standpoint.

Joshua's first recommendation was to go to the community with a broader sense of direction rather than a set of ideas and hear from the community what they want to see in their neighbourhood. He said that the best way to do this was to hold open houses and drop-in events. To reach people, he recommended using social media, but also dropping promotional flyers in people's mailboxes and putting up posters throughout the neighbourhood.

Joshua's suggestion for the pop-up events resonates with the advice Laura gave me a few days earlier. Making sure that people are compensated and creating a comfortable atmosphere is key. Also, hosting these events in an accessible place such as a park is important, as people are often likely to use this space regardless of the event.

Another recommendation he had was asking simple "Yes" or "No" questions if people are interested in signing up for future updates. This way people can get emails about any events or meetings that are happening in the area.

Building trust with the community was another notable recommendation. He said that "moving at the speed of trust" is really important: one way to do this is by dedicating enough time to meet with the community frequently, as regular meetings will foster a strong relationship.

The last point that Joshua made during our meeting was to always be prepared for any kind of questions. He said that the best way to do this was to anticipate what questions may be asked during the meetings.

Key Takeaways

- Approach with a broader sense of direction rather than a set idea
- Open house and drop-in events
  - Use social media, promotional flyers, and posters
- Hosting events in accessible places
- The trust-building process
  - "Move at the speed of trust"

4 FUTURE RECOMMENDATIONS

As Tenblock continues its advocacy efforts to promote the bike lane upgrade and bike extension to enhance the Flemmingdon Park and Throncliffe community's transportation infrastructure, the next step is gaining support and outreach. Through my conversations with stakeholders as well as my research, I have come up with a list of recommendations which I grouped into two sections - community engagement and media. My goal with these recommendations is to create a list of efforts that will set Tenblock ahead in its advocacy journey.

4.1 Community Engagement

Tenblock's greatest stakeholders in this campaign are the residents of the surrounding community. Creating opportunities to hear from these key stakeholders (residents) is important for their advocacy efforts. With the use of community engagement strategies, Tenblock will gain a stronger community connection, and understand their views on the problem, enabling them to create joint advocacy work in the community with other groups (Grassroots organizations etc). Flemington Park is home to a large group of newcomers. Although these residents may have language barriers, other cultural factors, or no interest in the efforts from afar, it is still extremely important to reach out the best you can. In fact, they may benefit from this opportunity the most; for many, active/public transportation is their only way of getting around.

4.1.1 Surveys

In assessing community perspectives on current bike lanes and the proposed Don Mills Road bike lane, a comprehensive approach is essential. This approach involves a blend of in-person and online surveys, alongside targeted outreach efforts to schools and organizations, to ensure broad community engagement. Leveraging social media platforms for survey promotion and collecting email addresses enables ongoing communication, engagement, facilitating updates, and involvement in the bike lane initiative. The significance of surveys in informing development decisions cannot be overstated, as they provide meaningful data, foster community involvement, and uphold ethical standards of voluntary participation and privacy protection.

A great example of a data-driven question is:

- How often do you see yourself using the proposed bike lane on Don Mills Road?
  - Every day
  - Often (4 to 6 times a week)
  - Sometimes (1 to 3 times a week)
  - Rarely (less than 4 times a month)
  - Never
  - Other:

This is a great data-driven question as it offers quantifiable responses, provides frequency options, helps understand the usage and offers flexibility due to the "other" option that could be filled. Moreover, the ethical considerations highlighted in the approach are commendable.

Ensuring voluntary participation and protecting respondents' privacy uphold fundamental rights and promote trust within the community. By clearly communicating the use of data and maintaining anonymity, the approach minimizes the risk of potential harm and respects individuals' autonomy. The benefits of this approach are multifaceted. It generates meaningful data and diverse insights from community members, providing a robust foundation for informed decision-making in bike lane developments. Additionally, by giving people a voice in the process, the approach fosters a sense of ownership and collaboration, strengthening community engagement and support for the initiative. Overall, this approach promotes inclusivity, data-driven decision-making, and participatory community development, ultimately leading to more effective and sustainable outcomes in bike lane projects.

To give a head start, I created a Survey (see Link 3. in the Appendix). I asked questions that will reveal how residents, workers, and other people who use this space feel about the conditions of bike lanes and their perceived safety.

4.1.2 Community Meetings and Open House Events

I proposed that TenBlock considers hosting community meetings and open house events to facilitate involvement and engagement for their advocacy efforts. This aspect of the project is important, as it allows affected residents to voice their concerns about the target initiatives. Being aware of their concerns is vital because addressing them will increase trust and support for the advocacy effort.

I recommend that these meetings include important stakeholders, such as community support groups, advocacy groups, and educational institutions nearby. These meetings should also ensure that residents of all ages and backgrounds are able to participate.

In terms of the meeting structure, I recommend that it includes the following aspects:

- Meetings should be highly interactive and engaging in nature, and hosts should be encouraged to act merely as facilitators to prevent discussions from heading off-topic, or potentially becoming heated.
- Discussions should be enjoyable for the public, and should not be too lengthy to ensure that people are able to take a reasonable amount of time out of their day to participate.

- Other stakeholders should be invited into these meetings in order to allow for them to voice potential thoughts or concerns from upcoming developments. Local businesses, residents and advocacy groups affiliated with Thorncliffe and Flemingdon Park (Thorncliffe Park Women's Committee, Friends of Thorncliffe Park, etc.) should all be invited to participate within these meetings.
- Open house events can be facilitated as small informational stations where participants can walk around and engage in interactive elements.
- It is also important to create a comfortable atmosphere and make sure that people want to be there, rather than feel like they have to. One way to do this is to offer compensation for people's time. I recommend providing snacks, food, coffee, care packages, and similar incentives.

I believe that these meetings should be every 90 days. This would provide a consistent opportunity for the public's voice to be heard adequately throughout the process. In addition, the gap between meetings would avoid potential redundancy as public interest may decline if meetings are too often. These meetings should happen before any official motion towards Council and during the implementation process in order to appropriately address additional concerns that arise during construction.

I also recommend that Tenblock ensures that meetings are scheduled at times that are most convenient and accessible for participants. Furthermore, Tenblock is highly encouraged to carefully select engagement strategies on a community-to-community basis to ensure that the public is kept up-to-date about upcoming meetings and discussions. This objective could be achieved by setting up information booths in the neighbourhood, having flyers, and ensuring the translation of the information into the most prominent languages of the community. These methods will allow for a bigger group of residents in the area to hear about the events, ultimately increasing participation. By doing such, there will be a greater number of people who are willing to support the initiatives brought forward by Tenblock.

Community meetings should be heavily considered by Tenblock for those living within 48 Grenoble, and can possibly be implemented within other sites if deemed to be successful for the area's context.

4.1.3 Pop-up Events

Traditional methods of public engagement, such as community meetings and open houses–with presentations, followed by visuals and a Q&A–can be effective, but often fall short in engaging with the entire community. The main obstacle is ensuring the attendance of all affected residents. Therefore, I recommend implementing pop-up community engagement as a way to inform the community and generate excitement and support for the initiative. Finding new ways to engage the public proves to be more difficult in a newcomer neighbourhood like Flemingdon Park because the majority of residents are not familiar with the system. These events will be designed to take place in areas where residents gather frequently. Unlike traditional workshops, pop-up engagements are casual and conversational, giving residents a platform to share their ideas and participate in upcoming events.

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The purpose of these events is to raise awareness about the proposed bike lane upgrades and additions on Don Mills Road, and gather community feedback and support. I encourage Tenblock to showcase the proposed bike lane and upgrades, safety benefits, and economic impact through large visuals and maps

Feedback stations should be created where attendees can provide suggestions regarding the new upgrade on a large interactive map where they can mark specific locations that they believe deserve more attention as well. Providing quick services such as a pump to fill tires, bike locks, lights, bells, and helmets that improve safety may encourage more people to incorporate biking in their daily routine. Additionally, once a resident gives their feedback, they get entered into a raffle for a chance to win a bike (one for a child and one for an adult). Tenblock can partner up with the Women's Cycling Network as they have an existing initiative wherein they donate bikes in the Flemingdon Park area to women. These events can also be in partnership with Park People and TCAT. It is estimated to cost $1000 and will cover the event planning, visual material, bike services and raffle prize (Bikes).

Another engagement Idea is to close off a parking lot (private or municipal) near a park or at one of the surrounding schools where you can create various roadways drawn in chalk and pylons etc, for children to learn road safety. Given the presence of multiple schools in the area, promoting biking for transportation offers important safety benefits and contributes to students' overall health and well-being. (See Traffic Gardens in Washington for more information on this pop-up tool list). This will also encourage parents to be supportive of the safety upgrades on the bike lanes. Partnerships that share this vision for road safety and the implementation of the bike lane upgrade and addition can include the Toronto District School Board, Friends of Thorncliffe Park, Thorncliffe Park Community Hub, Go Green Youth Centre (GGYC), Share The Road - Cycling Coalition, and The Gateway Bike Hub. Budgeting for this event normally ranges from $300 to $800. However, incorporating stakeholders, who may want to undertake joint advocacy efforts for road safety and encouraging biking to school may reduce the cost, and volunteers are encouraged to inquire about participation.

These ideas will not only encourage feedback and support for the campaign but also encourage biking in the community. I recommend setting up these engagements in local parks such as Ferrand Drive Park, Flemingdon Park Park, the Thorncliffe Market, local places of worship, Toronto Public Library Flemingdon Park Branch, Flemingdon Community Centre, Gateway Bike Hub, Schools (Grenoble Elementary, Gateway Public School, St. John XXIII Catholic School, Valley Park Middle School), The Long Exposure Festival, and more. Tenblock should also contact The Flemingdon Community Support Services (FCSS) to see organized community events coming up to install a booth. Marketing the next workshop or event through these pop-ups with “save the date” cards or posters that residents can photograph may also encourage more attendees at the next event (KTUA, 2017). Providing translators for these events may be necessary due to English not being residents' first language as well. Finally, snacks, water, and a smile must be provided at these events. All costs may be adjustable based on available resources and collaboration efforts to execute a pop-up engagement event like these.

4.1.4 Workshops and Cycling Events

To initiate community engagement and promote cycling in the neighbourhood, Tenblock could lead a series of workshops and cycling events. This is beneficial for skill development, education, community building, health and well-being, as well as fostering environmental stewardship. I suggest that Tenblock should hold cycling workshops and events within the community around 48 Grenoble Drive. I suggest that these events be held as webinars, guided bike tours, group rides, or in- person educational workshops. The workshops could cover a range of topics tailored to community interests. This can be workshops educating communities on topics such as:

- **Bike Maintenance -** Teach basic bike repairs, tire changes, and adjustments
- **Safety and Rules -** Educate participants on road safety, helmet use, and traffic rules
- **Health and Fitness -** Discuss the benefits of cycling for physical and mental health
- **Urban Cycling -** Address challenges specific to city cycling and how to overcome them

By connecting these workshops to practical examples, such as local cycling routes or common maintenance skills, attendees can better relate and apply what they learned from workshops. Organizing cycling events like group rides or bike tours can foster a sense of community and highlight local landmarks. Safety measures, such as providing helmets and reflective gear, should be prioritized to ensure participant well-being. Tenblock should focus on inclusivity and accessibility by offering workshops and events that accommodate diverse languages, different cultural backgrounds, and all age groups.

To hold the workshops or cycling events, Tenblock could secure local venues like community centers, schools, or parks. For events such as group rides it would be ideal to showcase safe cycling routes within the community that residents can take to get to important locations such as schools, community support services or places of worship. Promotion efforts could include creating flyers, and social media posts, and leveraging community networks for word-of-mouth outreach. Another approach could be inviting individuals who participated in previous surveys, leveraging their collected emails for outreach.

Considering aspects like venue rental costs and bike rentals is essential for the planning of these events. I encourage Tenblock to explore options for free or subsidized workshops through organizations like CycleTO which can help offset expenses. Public workshops offered by CycleTO, cover topics like cycling rules, safety, and basic bike maintenance and are free for both organizers and attendees.

However, for private workshops within businesses or government agencies, a fee may apply depending on factors like duration, content, and facilitators. For events such as group rides some residents may require a bike rental, and costs for those can vary, with hourly rates typically ranging from approximately $10.00 to $20.00 in Toronto. Tenblock should provide all necessary materials for the events, including bikes, safety equipment and other necessities. Providing all the required materials for events helps ensure that they remain accessible to all within the neighbourhood and also encourages residents to attend the events and experience new things.

Venue rental costs also vary based on factors like location, capacity, and amenities, with prices ranging from $50.00 to $1484.00 per hour or starting from $30.00 to $47.00 per person, using websites such as Tagvenue can assist Tenblock in locating venues within the area.

Post-event evaluation is a crucial tool for assessing success and refining future initiatives. Collecting feedback from participants and analyzing insights can guide improvements for future workshops and events. By implementing these strategies thoughtfully while managing costs effectively, Tenblock can foster community engagement, promote cycling, and create a more bike-friendly neighbourhood which is prepared to utilize the bike lanes along Don Mills Road.

4.2 Media

Media is the final section in gaining support for the advocacy campaign. I chose to implement media tools to create this campaign because the cost of media work is much lower in comparison to events.

4.2.1 Twitter/X

Twitter/X is a great tool for providing information about new urban developments due to its multifaceted features and diverse user base. One of its primary advantages is its capability for real-time updates. This will give people consistent updates on the current projects within the area. Tenblock could easily provide progress, announcements, upcoming events, public meetings, volunteer options, updates and news to multiple stakeholders, community members and organizations to ensure that everyone is kept informed promptly. This immediacy not only fosters transparency but also allows for consistent communication, community engagement, building of trust, and allows for concerns and questions to be answered promptly.

By leveraging hashtags, mentions, and retweets, Tenblock can amplify their messages and engage a diverse array of voices, ensuring that the development process reflects the needs and aspirations of the community. Moreover, the platform allows an option to create a poll as this is a great method to collect data and understand how people feel about certain aspects of the development. The platform's advertising capabilities further enhance its effectiveness as a tool for spreading awareness of new developments.

Also, Tenblock could create paid ads enabling targeted promotion of development-related content to specific demographics or geographic areas within the city, extending the reach of important information to residents who may not follow relevant accounts organically. With individuals from various demographic backgrounds, professions, and interests, the platform facilitates inclusive communication and engagement across diverse communities.

Lastly, by actively listening to community feedback, Tenblock can address concerns, adapt plans accordingly, and foster a sense of collective ownership of urban development initiatives. Overall, the platform's real-time updates, direct communication features, community engagement opportunities, advertising capabilities, diverse user base, bookmarking functionality, creating lists of important accounts, feedback mechanisms, and event promotion tools make it an invaluable platform for fostering awareness and dialogue about the development within the city.

4.2.2 LinkedIn

Utilizing business-based social media platforms such as LinkedIn can prove to be a useful tool in delivering transparency to the public eye, and I recommend Tenblock to continue its use alongside with other recommendations provided. Furthermore, events can be announced via this platform as well as used to post events to recap the key findings and who participated in each of these events.

For example, upon the completion of surveys, community meetings, workshops, or any other events conducted by Tenblock, there can be a post made on the company LinkedIn board informing the public of the key findings and successful community meetings/workshops that have been concluded. That way, even if one may not have participated in the event, they may feel intrigued by what is being posted by Tenblock and ultimately decide to participate in the next event that is announced.

Furthermore, stakeholders who participated in these events can create their own posts regarding these events, or repost Tenblock’s messages, ultimately allowing for announcements to be spread - effectively alerting the public. These posts created by both Tenblock and participating stakeholders can develop more connections within the realm of development, and help promote the company’s services to a broader audience that would not otherwise be available. For these reasons, I believe that Tenblock can benefit through continued use of LinkedIn, especially when paired with the other recommendations provided in this section.

4.2.3 Blogs and Newspapers

Blogs and local newspapers are another effective media tool used to reach diverse audiences efficiently. This traditional recommendation made for TenBlock helps broaden the outreach targeting the general public regarding the cycling advocacy plan created by TenBlock for the Flemingdon Park community. Through niche publications and municipal-focused newspapers such as, the Toronto Star and Spacing Magazine, allow the target audience to understand and partake in the development of the advocacy plan.

It is important to consider the main objective of utilizing newspapers as a media tool as they regularly have a high level of credibility and trustworthiness in the public eye. Lastly, people can access newspapers either online or printed allowing more people to be aware of the cycling advocacy plan/campaign for the Flemingdon Park community.

Moreover, blogs have a unique way for readers to interact with the posts. This can be utilized by gaining feedback, and input that can potentially enhance the advocacy plans. Additionally, TenBlock can collaborate with blogs such as BlogTO, to form a community base on the feedback that is received when implementing the Bike Lane. This will allow bike users, pedestrians, and residents to have a platform to introduce new ideas, opinions, and experiences that come along with the bike lanes and all of the advocacy efforts. TenBlock can utilize this feedback to understand the community's concerns, adjust advocacy strategies, and improve the proposed bike lanes with the help of the residents who are active users. Lastly, I recommend the use of blogs as there is a prominent online presence, where blogs/articles can be accessible and shared through numerous social media platforms - ultimately broadening the outreach for the advocacy plan.

By leveraging the credibility of newspapers and the interactive nature of blogs, the approach aims to foster community involvement and feedback, enhancing the advocacy plan's development and implementation. This multifaceted approach not only increases outreach but also facilitates active participation and collaboration, ultimately strengthening TenBlock's advocacy efforts.

4.2.4 Novae Res Urbis Article

The Novae Res Urbis (NRU) is a significant journal in the urban planning community that explores urban development and planning in the GTA. This is a great resource for anyone interested in planning, infrastructure projects, housing, policy changes and any other related topic about development or urban growth. I recommend Tenblock to utilize this resource to communicate the development proposal, initiatives, and any plans they have for the site to their audience. Also, the NRU is a solid method which allows TenBlock's communication and engagement to directly reach any relevant and interested parties/stakeholders.

This could help facilitate communication with experts from local government, academics, consulting businesses and non profit organizations as well. Furthermore, the NRU's papers, assessments, and articles provide insightful analyses of the intricacies of urban development, contributing to the advancement of knowledge and comprehension of real-world events. The NRU provides a platforms for engagement, such as letters to the editor, opinion pieces, and community forums. This allows for meaningful interaction and feedback from readers about the TenBlock initiatives, enabling other developers to gather input and address concerns directly. Overall, leveraging NRU serves as an effective method for TenBlock to disseminate information, engage stakeholders, and contribute to the broader discourse on urban development in the GTA.

4.3 Getting Decision-Makers on Board

The final step in advocating for the improvement of active transportation is to bring the proposal within the walls of City Hall. Getting decision-makers on board is arguably the most crucial step of the engagement process.

To ensure support from the relevant stakeholders and decision-makers, engaging with them throughout the planning process is vital. Contacting the City of Toronto's Transportation and Urban Development staff members to evaluate the existing conditions of the bike lanes on the site. Advocates can prompt change to the current bike infrastructure through open communication with city staff. These meetings demonstrate that there is support for the identified initiatives, motivating policymakers to support TenBlock's cause in the decision-making process.

Political support is the most significant component of implementing the proposed bike lanes on Don Mills and improving the existing active transportation networks within Flemingdon Park. Through this project, I have outlined methods and strategies through which Tenblock may achieve optimal community support. Support from the community is vital to the decision making process as it plays an important role in the application to the Council.

Beyond the detailed strategies discussed above to garner community support, simultaneous research of the policy landscape is also important for the viability of this proposal. Having a comprehensive application that examines the localized needs and demands of a community while also understanding the broader city objective will lead to higher chances of political support and approval. Through my interviews with various Ward Council representatives, I understand that the Council may be interested in a few points of analysis which include:

- Analysis of previous and current projects relating to protected bike lane developments around the neighbourhood.
    - Understanding how adding to the city bicycle network aligns with existing plans will result in more convincing arguments.
    - For instance, a project such as the Sheppard Complete Streets Plan, conducted by Ward 17 is a great starting point for understanding the priorities and strategic goals of the city.

When approaching the local Councillors, a comprehensive proposal will ensure a more resilient case. Alternatively, it is critical that city staff is involved in understanding the impacts of proposed initiatives and improvements. In terms of development processes, this stage can be looked at as the Pre-Consultation step. It is essential to consult city planning members prior to bringing a motion with the City Council to ensure the credibility and viability of the proposal. Communicating with Community Planning, Urban Design, and Transportation Planning staff for advice and proposal evaluation will also contribute to its success with Council. As city planning divides planning staff by Wards, it is recommended that the staff of Ward 16 be consulted as the first step.

5 CONCLUSION

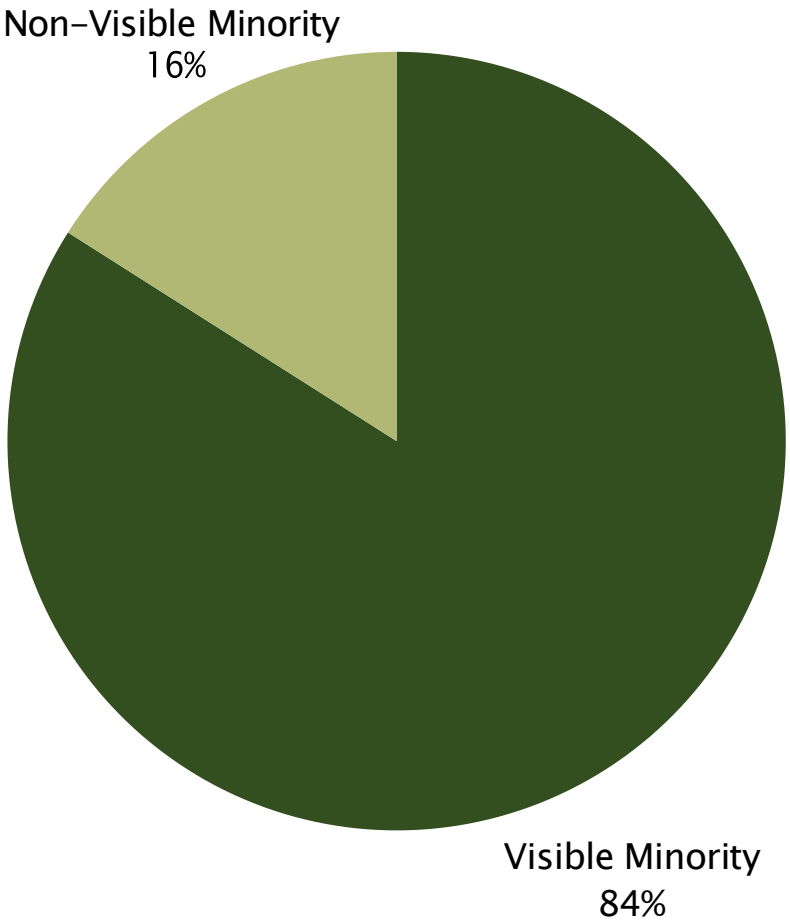
In conclusion, this advocacy plan marks a significant milestone in the collaborative partnership with TMU's Urban and Regional Planning Student Consultants and Tenblock. Through comprehensive research analysis and advocacy efforts, I have identified 48 Grenoble Drive as the target initiative for the implementation of bike lanes along Don Mills and improvements to the existing bike lanes within Flemingdon Park. The strong history of neighborhood support for similar initiatives and the presence of cycling advocacy groups within this community informed this decision, as they align with Tenblock's goal of creating vibrant communities connected by reliable and sustainable transportation networks.

Community engagement serves as the cornerstone of Tenblock's advocacy efforts for the proposed Don Mills Road bike lane and bike lane improvements. Through a multifaceted approach that utilizes surveys, community meetings, pop-up engagements, and workshops, Tenblock will be able foster inclusivity, gather meaningful feedback, and promote active participation from the Flemington Park community. By using social media tools to enhance awareness, Tenblock can provide real-time updates, facilitate dialogue, and reach diverse audiences. Furthermore, leveraging traditional media channels enables Tenblock to amplify their message, legitimize their advocacy efforts, and effectively engage with urban planning stakeholders. Proactive engagement will ensure alignment with city objectives, address community needs, and increase the likelihood of political support.

Moving forward, my recommendations will guide the implementation of and support for sustainable transportation initiatives surrounding Tenblock's development project, ensuring a lasting positive impact on communities and the broader urban landscape.

APPENDIX A - FIGURES

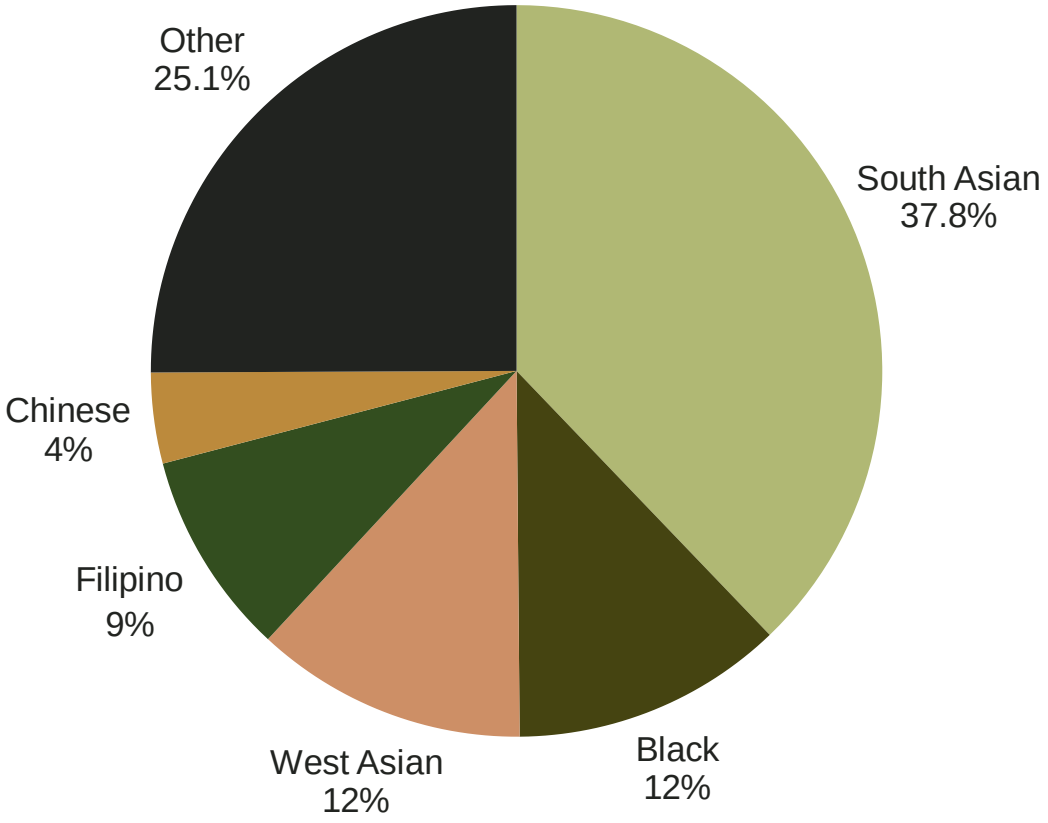
Figure 1. on Page 05



POPULATION BY VISIBLE AND NON-VISIBLE MINORITY

APPENDIX A - FIGURES

Figure 2. on Page 05



MOST POPULATED ETHNICITIES

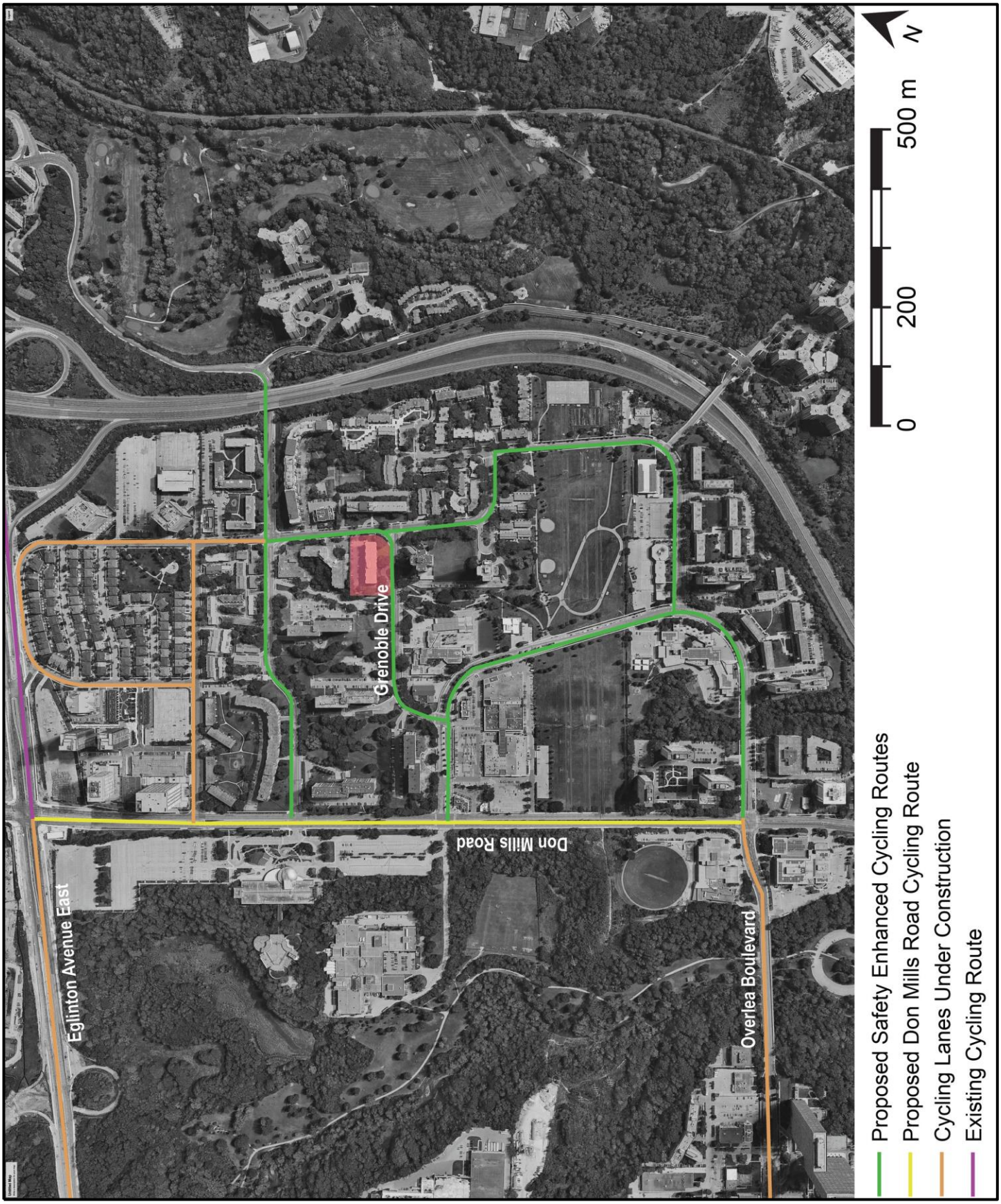
APPENDIX A - FIGURES

Figure 3. on Page 06

	Political Support	Cost	Existing Planned Directions	Existing Adovacy Efforts	Integration
Bike Lane Condition Upgrades and Connection Expansions	B	B	A	A	A
Public Bike Shelters and Storage Implementations	C	C	A	B	A
Educational Cycling Programs Incorporation	C	A	A	A	B
Speed Hump Additions	C	C	B	C	D
Pedestrian Crosswalk Upgrades	B	B	A	A	A

APPENDIX A - FIGURES

Figure 4. on Page 06



APPENDIX A - FIGURES

Figure 5. on Page 06

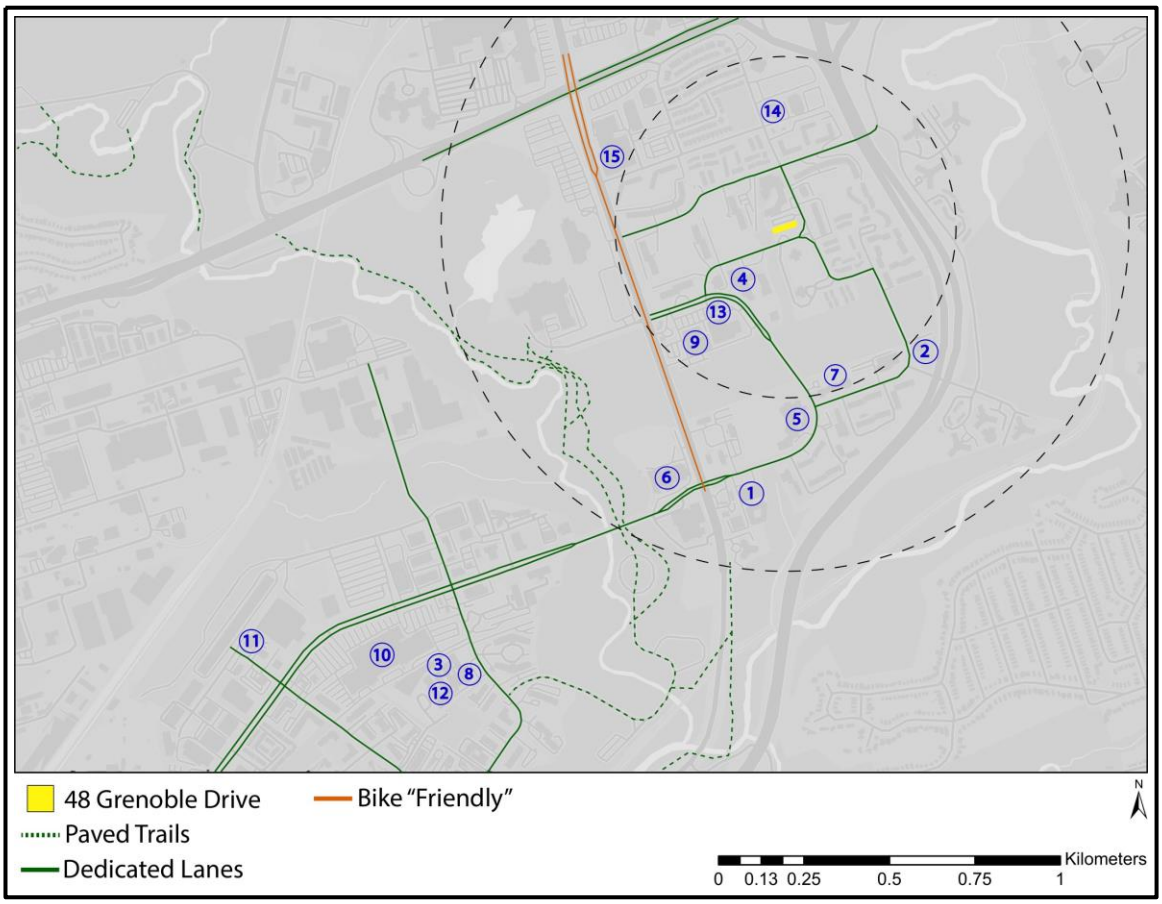


Figure 6. on Page 06

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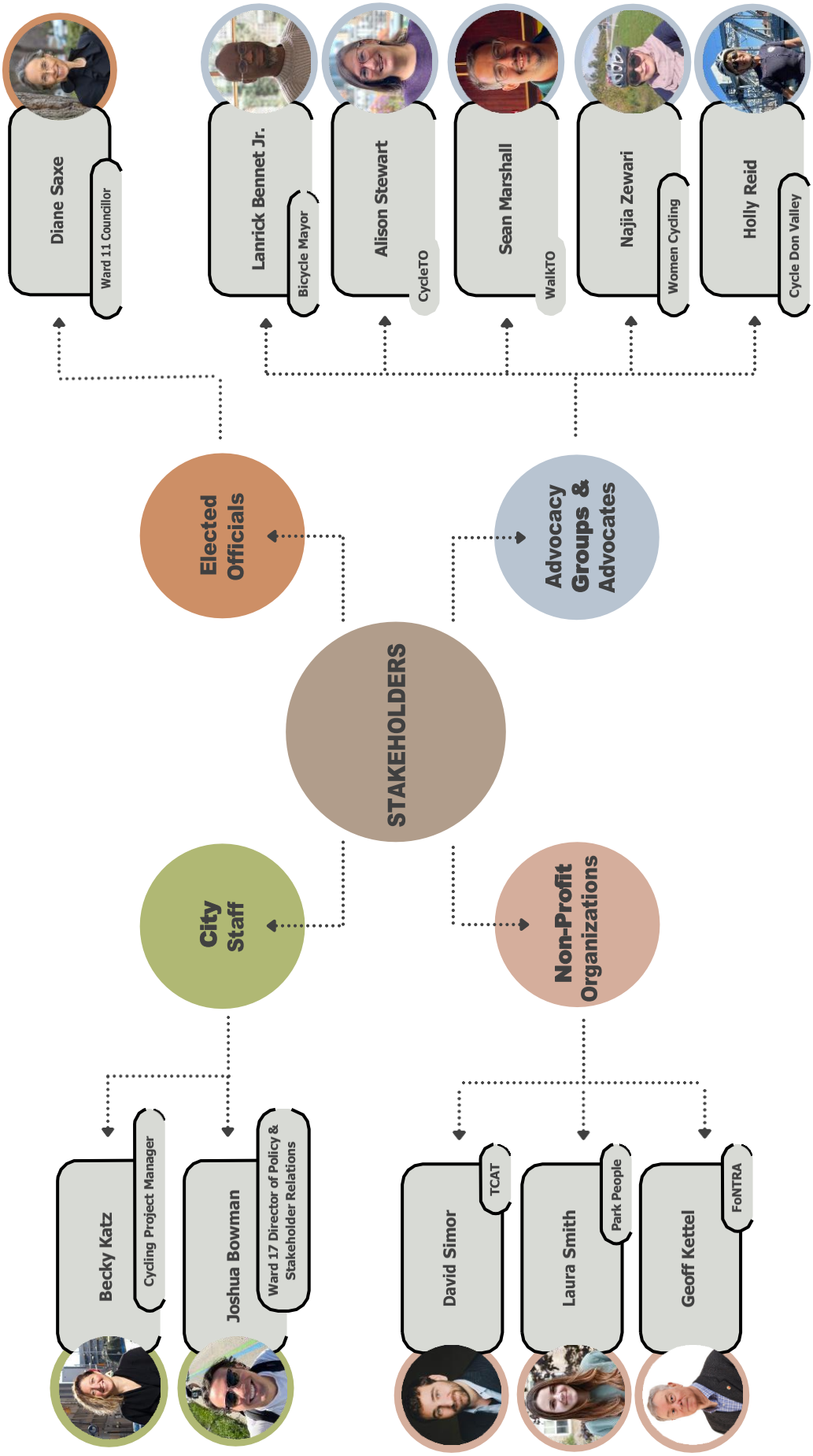
APPENDIX A - FIGURES

Figure 7. on Page 07



APPENDIX B - LINKS

Link 1. on Page 07

https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/14xcda_-Duj64Ja5UH-PFpqsqLg7gsBdg /edit?usp=sharing_&ouid=102521738356437442845&rtpof=true&sd=true

Link 2. on Page 07

https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1-g_DOiOmYq_R9ff0VJ8qVQUMItkdls7uy_/edit?usp=sharing_&ouid=102521738356437442845&rtpof=true&sd=true

Link 3. on Page 20

https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSfkk-8lJ9pM9aufyPqQbZsI-s606f8vp-qCK01nBUscH4kyaQ/viewform?usp=sf_link

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